THE GOSPEL VAULT · VAULT 1 · THE GOSPEL · CHARTS

Eternal Life / Salvation: God's Free Gift

A six-panel walkthrough of what the Bible — especially the Gospel of John — says it takes to receive eternal life, and what it does not.

1 The Question	2 Why John's Gospel	3 Believe	4 No Additions	5 Assurance	6 In Every Language

Ten charts · Ephesians 2:8–9 · John 20:31 · 1 John 5:13 · thegospelvault.com

Six panels, one argument

The walkthrough at a glance · thegospelvault.com/free-gift

1 The Question

Salvation is a free gift — so what do you actually have to do to receive it?

2 Why John's Gospel

One Gospel states its purpose outright: "that you may believe."

3 Believe

The one condition, pictured six ways: look, hear, enter, drink, come, receive.

4 No Additions

No qualifiers on faith, and no repentance or surrender tacked on as extra conditions.

5 Assurance

You can know — not just hope — that you have eternal life.

6 In Every Language

John 3:16 — the same promise in 48 languages, to share in someone else's own tongue.

"For by grace you have been saved through faith; and that not of yourselves, it is the gift of God." — Ephesians 2:8

A free gift — or a gift with a price tag?

Panel 1 · The Question · Ephesians 2:8–9; Romans 4:5; 5:1

What Scripture says the gift is

Eph 2:8–9
By grace … through faith … the gift of God; not as a result of works

Rom 4:5
To the one who does not work, but believes … his faith is credited as righteousness

Rom 5:1
Having been justified by faith, we have peace with God

vs

The price tags people add

- Repent of your sins
- Confess Jesus before others
- Ask Him into your heart
- Make Him Lord of your life
- Promise to serve Him
- Go forward at church
- Join a church
- Be baptized
- Make a decision for Christ
- Accept Him as Lord and Savior

Some of these may be good things a believer eventually does — but is any one of them the condition for receiving eternal life?

Four Gospels, four portraits — one stated purpose

Panel 2 · Why John's Gospel · Matt 23:37; Mark 10:45; Luke 19:10; John 20:30–31

Matthew The King of Israel	**Mark** The Suffering Servant	**Luke** The Son of Man	**John** The Christ, the Son of God
Longing over Jerusalem like a hen gathering her chicks	Came not to be served, but to serve, and to give His life a ransom for many	Came to seek and to save that which was lost	*"These have been written so that you may believe … and that believing you may have life in His name"*
Matt 23:37–39	Mark 10:45	Luke 19:10	John 20:30–31

Matthew, Mark and Luke show their purpose through what they chose. John states his outright — he wrote to answer exactly this question.

One sentence, three things

Panel 2 · Why John's Gospel · John 20:31; John 1:1

"…these have been written so that you may believe that Jesus is the Christ, the Son of God; and that believing you may have life in His name." — John 20:31

1

Who Jesus is

The Christ, the Son of God — fully God: "In the beginning was the Word, and the Word was God"

John 1:1

2

The response He is after

Believe — not do, promise, or perform

John 20:31a

3

What it gets you

Life in His name — eternal life

John 20:31b

If you want to know what it takes to receive eternal life, this is the Gospel written specifically to answer that.

"Believe" — the word John built his Gospel on

Panel 3 · Believe · Count of "believe" in the New Testament

98

times in John

34

in Matthew, Mark and Luke combined

16

in the rest of the New Testament

What it means: to trust in someone, convinced that what he said is true. Faith in John is trusted reliance on Christ's promise to give eternal life to those who believe.

"He who hears My word, and believes Him who sent Me, has eternal life … and has passed out of death into life." — John 5:24 · Present tense, settled now.

Six pictures, one act

Panel 3 · Believe · How John pictures believing

Look
John 3:14–15

As Moses lifted up the serpent … whoever believes will in Him have eternal life

Hear
John 10:16, 27

My sheep hear My voice, and I know them, and they follow Me

Enter
John 10:9

I am the door; if anyone enters through Me, he will be saved

Drink
John 4:14

Whoever drinks of the water that I will give him shall never thirst

Come
John 5:40; 6:37; 7:37

The one who comes to Me I will certainly not cast out

Receive
John 1:12

As many as received Him, to them He gave the right to become children of God

Simple trust in what Christ has promised — nothing hidden, nothing added.

No qualifiers on faith

Panel 4 · No Additions · John uses "true" — but never on believing

Where John does write "true"

- the true light — John 1:9
- true worshippers — John 4:23
- the true bread — John 6:32
- disciples indeed — John 8:31
- the true vine — John 15:1
- the true God — John 17:3

vs

What John never writes

- ✕ "whoever really believes"
- ✕ "whoever truly believes"
- ✕ "genuine faith"
- ✕ "real faith"
- ✕ "effectual faith"

One either believes, or he does not believe. There is no hidden second tier of "believing enough."

No extra conditions standing next to faith

Panel 4 · No Additions · John 4:10, 14; 12:42; 19:38–39

Repentance?

The Samaritan woman was never told to repent. Jesus offered her eternal life for the asking and the drinking — both pictures of believing.

Repentance as a change of mind happens as a person believes — not a separate work on top of faith.

John 4:10, 14

Commitment?

Salvation is received, not earned or bargained for. A believer gives his life to Christ after believing.

Commitment follows salvation; it does not purchase it.

Free gift

Public confession?

Joseph of Arimathea, Nicodemus and some of the rulers believed but, out of fear, did not confess Jesus openly.

John still counts them among those who believed.

John 12:42; 19:38–39

Faith alone in Christ alone — a simple, unconditional, non-meritorious response of accepting and trusting God's promise.

You can know you have eternal life

Panel 5 · Assurance · John 1:29; 3:16; 20:31; 1 John 5:11–13

1

Faith needs an object

Not believing hard enough, but who you trust: the Son of God (20:31), the Lamb who takes away sin (1:29), risen (John 20).

2

Invite people to believe

Not "ask Jesus into your heart," "give your life," or "surrender as Lord" — believe in Christ as Savior.

3

Assurance rests on the Word

Not on feelings, performance, or a memorable moment. God's own testimony is sufficient.

4

Keep the gospel free

The sin that condemns is unbelief; the cure for unbelief is belief in what Christ has finished.

"These things I have written to you who believe … so that you may know that you have eternal life." — 1 John 5:13
Not hope. Not guess. Know.

Not because your faith was strong enough, but because His promise was.

PANEL 6 · IN EVERY LANGUAGE

"For God so loved the world, that He gave His only begotten Son, that whoever believes in Him shall not perish, but have eternal life."

John 3:16 · NASB95 — and the same promise in 48 languages at thegospelvault.com/free-gift/panel-6.html

Chinese (Simplified)	Hindi	Spanish	Arabic	French	Portuguese
Bengali	Indonesian	Urdu	Russian	German	Swahili
Japanese	Marathi	Vietnamese	Telugu	Turkish	Tagalog
Hausa	Punjabi	Tamil	Persian	Korean	Amharic
Thai	Javanese	Italian	Gujarati	Kannada	Yoruba
Nigerian Pidgin	Chinese (Traditional)	Malayalam	Polish	Igbo	Ukrainian
Burmese	Odia	Malay	Afaan Oromo	Nepali	Dutch
Romanian	Sinhala	Khmer	Zulu	Cebuano	Pashto

Believe His promise today — in your own language.